Economic importance	Binomial	Useful part	Uses
Ornamental Plants	*Butea frondosa* (Flame of the forest), *Clitoria ternatea*, *Lathyrus odoratus* (Sweet pea) and *Lupinus hirsutus* (Lupin)	Entire plant	Grown as ornamental plants.

Diabetes Remedy

The aerial parts of *Galega officinalis* (Fabaceae) contains Metformin (dimethyl biguanide). It is now reputed to be the most widely prescribed agent in the treatment of diabetes all over the world.



The attractive seeds of *Adenanthera pavonina* (Family: Caesalpiniaceae) have been used as units of weight for the measures of gold throughout India.



The seeds of *Abrus precatorius* are used in necklaces and rosaries, but are extremely poisonous and can be fatal if ingested.





The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations has been declared 2016 as the year for pulses, to make people more aware of the nutritional value of pulses.

5.13.2 Family: Solanaceae (Potato Family / Night shade family)



Systematic Position

APG system of classification		Bentham and Hooker system of classification	
Kingdom	Plantae	Kingdom	Plantae
Clade	Angiosperms	Class	Dicotyledonae
Clade	Eudicot	Subclass	Gamopetalae
Clade	Asterids	Series	Bicarpellatae
Clade	Solanales	Order	Polemoniales
Family	Solanaceae	Family	Solanaceae

General Characters

Distribution:

Family Solanaceae includes about 88 genera and about 2650 species, of these *Solanum* is the largest genus of the family with about 1500 species. Plants are worldwide in distribution but more abundant in South America.

Habit: Mostly annual herbs, shrubs, small trees (*Solanum violaceum*) lianas with prickles (*Solanum trilobatum*)

Root: Branched tap root system.

Stem: Herbaceous or woody; erect or twining, or creeping; sometimes modified into tubers (*Solanum tuberosum*) it is covered with Spines (*Solanum tuberosum)*

Leaves: Alternate, simple, rarely pinnately compound (*Solanum tuberosum* and *Lycopersicon esculentum*, exstipulate, opposite or sub-opposite in upper part, unicostate reticulate venation. Yellowish verbs present in *Solanum tuberosum*

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